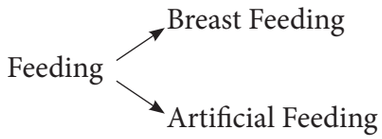
6.5.1 Types of Feeding



Breast feeding: The two important reasons for breast feeding is avoidance of infections and survival.

Advantages of Breast Feeding

1. Ideal composition for easy digestion with low osmatic load.
2. Protection against infection and deficiency disorders.
3. Breast milk are readily available in body temperature and sterile.
4. Requiring no preparation and costs nothing.
5. It has laxative action.
6. No danger of allergy.
7. Maintains healthy mother and child relationship.
8. Chance of conception is less during lactation.
9. Helps in the involution of the uterus.
10. Reduces the risk of breast and ovarian cancer of mother.
11. Breast feeding protects the infant from allergy and bronchial asthma. It also protects against tetany, neonatal hypoglycemia and vitamin deficiencies.
12. It is essential for the brain growth of an infant.

6.5.2 Common Problems in Breast Feeding

Even though breast milk is best to feed the baby as it offers a lot more than just nutrition. There are several challenges in breast feeding. They are

1. Due to mother
2. Due to infant

Due to Mother

1. Reluctance
2. over anxiety
3. Following operative surgery
4. Maternal illness
5. Inadequate secretion
6. Breast ailments

Due to Infant

1. Low birth weight babies
2. Preterm babies
3. Temporary illness
4. Over distension of the foetal stomach
5. Congenital malformation like cleft palate etc

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